



PROGRESS REPORT

Central Africa: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-08 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Compiled 2026-09-08 by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository. Sections run from the region's institutions outwards to what funds them. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · INSTITUTIONS AND MANDATES · INSTRUMENTS AND HARMONISATION ·
SHARED SYSTEMS AND INFRASTRUCTURE · CAPACITY AND INCLUSION · FINANCE

Of 43 bodies, instruments and systems on this place's ledger, 32 changed position between 2025-09-01 and 2026-09-08, 1 did not, 10 carry no stated baseline, and 0 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 71 sources for this place in the window — 24 in the earlier half (2025-09 to 2026-03), 47 in the later (2026-04 to 2026-09). The two halves are comparable, so the comparison is made over the whole window.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

CEMAC's monetary union is the layer that delivers: over the period it launched a community-wide interoperable QR-code payment standard, put SYSTAC 2 into production for retail payments across all six member states, and joined PAPSS, alongside a [regional financial-inclusion strategy targeting 60% inclusion by 2029](#). ECCAS, the wider political community covering the same six core states, has the weaker record — its 1983 free-movement protocol remains unimplemented four decades on, against CEMAC's own free-movement act only beginning enforcement in 2024 and still refused by two members. A telecommunications-regulators body, ARTAC, produced the period's most consequential single institutional output: a data-sovereignty recommendation aimed at satellite constellations and a roaming mandate dated to June 2026. Statistical harmonisation moved on two fronts — labour and industrial production — both still short of an adopted instrument.

Below the institutions, the physical layer moved faster than anything that governs it. The Central African Backbone extended in three directions at once: Congo's 600 km link to Cameroon and the Central African Republic, [Cameroon seeking US\\$195 million to expand its own under a presidential decree of March 2026](#), and [Congo Telecom restating an ambition to lead regional digital transit](#). Four states are building national data centres and every one of them frames it as digital sovereignty — Brazzaville's US\$72.8 million facility [90% complete by August 2025 for a](#)

November launch and Gabon inaugurating the region's first Tier III site in July 2026. The counter-current runs the other way: the Central African Republic is seeking an interconnection through South Sudan to reduce its dependence on the region's own fragile networks, a route out of CEMAC rather than through it.

On payments the central bank spent the period arguing with its own members. It came out firmly against excessive taxation of mobile money, warning that transaction taxes penalise low-income households and hold back financial inclusion — a position stated against a regional strategy targeting 60% inclusion by 2029, with no member state's tax changed on the record. Four new payment providers were licensed or partnered into the zone inside the same year, which is the market answering a question the tax regime has not.

Institutions and mandates

Regional collaboration

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
Africa CDC Central Africa health-data sharing roadmap	Did not exist	Roadmap sets a six-week deadline for drafting an inter-country convention on cross-border health-data sharing and a four-week deadline for a formal sharing mechanism, to be put to the health ministers of the seven of nine Central African member states that have yet to sign the underlying protocol, after experts worked through data-protection, confidentiality and sovereignty obstacles	ADVANCED
ARTAC (Central African Telecommunications Regulators Conference)	A standing regional regulators' body with no dated recent record held	10th Ordinary Session (Kinshasa) adopted revised statutes, internal regulations and financial rules, extended the Executive Committee's mandate to December 2027, recommended a harmonised NGSO framework requiring satellite providers (Starlink, OneWeb, Amazon Kuiper named) to establish terrestrial gateways within ARTAC's jurisdiction and keep citizens' data stored within Africa, and mandated free roaming across Central Africa by 30 June 2026; separately co-organised a sub-regional fibre-infrastructure mapping workshop with the ITU in N'Djamena, 15-18 December 2025	ADVANCED
Central Africa regional digital market policy and framework law 2025-2030	Did not exist	A regional workshop attended by all ten member states of the economic community plus the monetary community produced a 2025-2030 regional digital-trade policy and a framework law covering harmonised data-protection and cybersecurity rules and free movement of data across the region's economic space; both texts await political endorsement and no endorsement date is published	ADVANCED
Regional framework on cross-border data governance	Did not exist	Consultations closed at Douala on 4 September 2026 with 27 participants and European Union and German development backing, a regional data governance framework and an accompanying roadmap due out of them (2026-09)	ADVANCED
Cameroon-Chad digital cooperation agreement	Not held	Concluded between the two communications ministries as a bilateral step inside the region's digital integration (2025-05)	BASELINE NOT HELD
Regional harmonisation of remittance policies (ECCAS)	Not held	Country diagnostics on remittance policy and its regional harmonisation, on data through November 2023 (2025-04)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Public debate and participation in policymaking

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
Independent research on the region's digital systems	Scattered work with no standing body of regional analysis	Three independent accounts inside a year: criminal capture of a cryptocurrency scheme in the Central African Republic, a country study finding the Republic of Congo's digital ambitions will stall without policy change, and an analysis attributing triple-cost rural connectivity to backhaul spectrum fees (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Both rows on this section are new to the ledger this period. ARTAC's Kinshasa session did more than institutional housekeeping: its NGSO recommendation is a data-sovereignty position aimed squarely at Starlink, OneWeb and Amazon Kuiper, and its free-roaming mandate carries a dated deadline of 30 June 2026 that the base holds no confirmation was met. Africa CDC's health-data roadmap for Central Africa is earlier in its life — a workshop output with two short deadlines still running and seven of nine member states yet to sign the underlying data-sharing protocol.

Instruments and harmonisation

Strategies, plans and policies

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
CEMAC Regional Financial Inclusion Strategy (SRIF) 2025-2029	Did not exist; national financial-inclusion strategies existed only in Chad, Cameroon and the Central African Republic, and no member state had a national financial-education strategy	Sets a financial-inclusion target of 60% by 2029 and 75% by 2032, against a 32% baseline in 2021; six strategic axes and 68 actions across 24 objectives, budgeted at FCFA 43.8bn; developed over 30 months with more than 200 stakeholders across the six member states, World Bank-financed via a regional-institutions capacity project	ADVANCED

Legislation and regulation

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
CEMAC free-movement regime (Additional Act of 2019)	Additional act of 1 April 2019 exempts nationals of the six member states from visas for stays up to 90 days on presentation of a biometric national ID, CEMAC ID, biometric passport or approved CEMAC passport	Five years after enactment, two national police instructions applied it for the first time, following the fourth CCPAC (Central African police chiefs' committee) security session in Yaoundé; Gabon and Equatorial Guinea are named as continuing to refuse application	ADVANCED
ECCAS free-movement protocol (Annex VII, 1983 Treaty)	ECCAS founded 18 October 1983 by the former UDEAC members plus the CEPGL states, Angola and Sao Tome and Principe, carrying a free-movement-of-persons-and-goods annex from the outset	Annex VII is found not effectively implemented over four decades, attributed to poor infrastructure and communication links, political instability and rivalry between heads of state, and routine roadblocks within and across borders; ECCAS itself hibernated 1992-1998	STALLED

Data protection

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
CEMAC Regulation 01/20 on protection of banking consumers	Not held	Community consumer-protection rules for users of banking, microfinance and payment services across the six member states: fair treatment, information and transparency duties, contractual balance, data-protection duties, complaint-handling and mediation	BASELINE NOT HELD

Standards

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
CEMAC interoperable QR-code payment standard	Piloted nationally as Gabon's MaDigiPaie QR code, launched Libreville 9 December 2025 with more than 1,000 codes deployed at launch	BEAC and GIMAC launched the community-wide interoperable QR code at Douala, letting any bank, microfinance or mobile-money app scan any merchant's code across all six states through GIMACPAY to EMVCo standards, with 24 institutions already in production as at 29 July; GIMACPAY carried 20.3m transactions worth FCFA 863bn in 2025 (+40% by volume) across 153 participants; a tariff-revision workshop opened 30 July, cutting interoperability tariffs and capping merchant payments at 1%, not yet in force (hoped for 1 January 2027); merchant payment remains under 1% of interoperable traffic (48,605 transactions, FCFA 9.7bn, Q1 2026). The ministerial committee that adopted the regulation homologated standards for automated bills of exchange and automatic direct debit alongside the QR code, so the instrument is wider than this row's name	ADVANCED
GIMAC PCI DSS v4.0.1 certification	Certified under a prior PCI DSS version	GIMAC's card-data processing and transmission infrastructure recertified to PCI DSS v4.0.1	ADVANCED
ISO 20022 adoption across the community payment systems	Did not exist	The central bank mandated community-wide adoption of ISO 20022 messaging - cross-border payments rules for international flows and bank-specific formats for the two regional payment systems - on a migration timetable running from November 2025 to May 2026, and a companion circular put the message specifications online through a closed community area of the messaging network's standards portal	ADVANCED

AI

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
AfroLeadership proposal to integrate AU data governance into CEMAC AI policy	Did not exist	AfroLeadership argues the AU Data Policy Framework and a data-justice lens should shape how the CEMAC six approach AI governance, on the ground that AI systems process data at a scale existing governance mechanisms were not built for; the brief itself frames CEMAC as the regional economic community least represented in the wiki's AI material	ADVANCED

CEMAC's two 2019-era free-movement instruments sit at opposite ends of the delivery spectrum from ECCAS's: the CEMAC additional act only reached national implementing instructions in 2024, five years after enactment, and two of six members still decline to apply it, while the older ECCAS protocol has gone unimplemented since 1983. The financial-inclusion strategy and the CEMAC QR-code standard are the period's clearer advances, both carrying

dated targets and, in the QR standard's case, live transaction figures (20.3m transactions, FCFA 863bn in 2025) rather than announcements alone — though the QR standard's own tariff revision is not yet in force. The AfroLeadership AI-governance proposal remains exactly that: a civil-society brief, not a CEMAC decision.

Shared systems and infrastructure

Connectivity

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
Central Africa Peering Forum	Did not exist	Central Africa's own regional peering event, covering peering, interconnection, routing security and RPKI, closing a 2026 calendar that already ran West Africa's forum in Cotonou (June) and the continental AfPIF in Kigali (August)	ADVANCED
Central African Backbone	National segments built and interconnected — the Central African Republic's national backbone inaugurated in February 2023 with an interconnection to Congo	Extending in three directions at once: Congo's 600 km backbone linking Cameroon and the Central African Republic, Cameroon seeking USD 195 million to expand its own, and Congo Telecom stating an ambition to lead regional digital transit (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Central African Republic interconnection through South Sudan	Not held	Announced to reduce dependence on fragile regional networks and improve access to international capacity (2026-05)	BASELINE NOT HELD
Nigeria-Equatorial Guinea subsea cable	Not held	Signed to expand broadband capacity and regional cybersecurity between West and Central Africa (2026-02)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Data Storage

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
National data centres across the region	One national data centre under construction at Brazzaville, about 60 per cent complete in May 2024	Four national builds running: Brazzaville at USD 72.8 million and 90 per cent complete by August 2025 for a November launch, Gabon's first Tier III facility inaugurated in July 2026, Cameroon's carrier facility drawing central-bank interest, and Chad negotiating one with Azerbaijan (2026-07)	ADVANCED
PIDA data-centre infrastructure prospectus (ECCAS)	Did not exist	The AU's Programme for Infrastructure Development in Africa (PIDA) published a project prospectus for data-centre infrastructure development framed at ECCAS/ regional level, underpinning the digital economy; no financing, sponsor or timetable is stated in the prospectus itself	ADVANCED

Cybersecurity

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
ITU regional Cyberdrill (Central Africa)	Twelve prior editions held	13th ITU regional Cyberdrill convened agencies and defence forces from across Central Africa to test cross-border incident response; Congo's Prime Minister framed national cybersecurity as a sovereignty question at the opening, and Congo's ANSSI is named as the government's technical arm; ITU's own loss and attack-rate figures cited at the opening are not independently held; a first Central Africa cybersecurity conference was separately announced for Brazzaville in June 2026, with no further detail published	ADVANCED

Data Exchange

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
Central Africa Credit Information Bureau (CICA)	Authorised as the community credit information bureau by Governor's Decision 142/GR/2025 of 25 November 2025	Launched by the central bank with an international finance institution on a hub-and-spokes model based in Douala, with 61 financial institutions across the six member states connected to the test platform - a community-wide regime for sharing borrower credit data across borders	ADVANCED
I-CEMAC (INTERPOL border-management project)	Project launched 2019, targeting extension of INTERPOL's I-24/7 network and databases to 40 border points and modernisation of all six CEMAC national INTERPOL bureaux	Gabon completed four border posts with automated database searches (Eboro, Myo-Kye, Leconi, Port-Gentil, March 2024); Equatorial Guinea extended I-24/7 to ten sites including the Malabo, Bata and Mongomeyen airports; Cameroon's connected sites (Douala/Yaounde) logged more than 6,000 searches in 72 hours	ADVANCED

Digital Payments and Fintech

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
BEAC accession to PAPSS	Not a member	BEAC formally joined PAPSS, extending the continental real-time cross-border settlement rail into the CEMAC zone, with CEMAC banks' integration targeted by end-2026; as at 25 August, Cameroonian businesses report no operational access, and no public list of operational Cameroonian banks, open corridors, tariffs or ceilings has been published	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
CEMAC Regulation 04/18 on payment services	Not held	Regulation 04/18 remains in force and a draft 2026 replacement is under consideration, envisaged to enter into force on 1 January 2027: mandatory strong authentication, a reversed burden of proof on fraud disputes, a protected fund-safeguarding account for payment institutions, market opening to fintechs and aggregators, and a twelve-month regulatory sandbox	ADVANCED
Central bank instruction on inbound remittance pre-financing	Did not exist	Supplementing the community payment-services regulation, credit institutions must verify on concordant bank and messaging-network evidence that inbound remittance pre-financing executed through payment institutions has been matched by repayment - a rule bearing directly on the safety of funds credited to electronic-money wallets	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
Licensing of new payment providers in the zone	A payments unicorn licensed in Cameroon through a bank partnership (2025-06)	Four entrants licensed or partnered inside a year: a payments company in Cameroon through a bank partnership, a card network with a Cameroonian bank, a fintech with the International Finance Corporation in Chad, and a payment aggregator formally recognised in Congo (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Regional central bank accession to the continental payment system	Not participating (2025-08)	The regional central bank joined the continental instant payment and settlement network in July 2026, connecting the six member states it serves to a network spanning twenty-eight countries (2026-07)	ADVANCED
SYSTAC 2 (BEAC regional retail-payment platform)	A retail clearing platform in service since 2007	Centralised, fully online ISO 20022-compliant platform for transfers, direct debits, cheques and card payments across all six CEMAC states, with strengthened AML/KYC and a dedicated dispute-resolution module; the instant-payments module is explicitly not yet in production, no date given; the RTGS successor SYGMA V10 is described only as coming "in the coming weeks", also undated	ADVANCED
Taxation of mobile money in the CEMAC zone	Mobile money taxed at national discretion with no stated regional position	The central bank came out firmly against excessive taxation of mobile money, warning that transaction taxes penalise low-income households and hold back financial inclusion, and called for a concerted approach (2026-03)	REGRESSED
CEMAC payment services report	Published annually by the central bank	Published for 2024 as the zone's statistical account of payment services (2026-04)	NO CHANGE
GIMACPAY interoperability platform	Not held	The community's converged card, mobile and money-transfer interoperability platform, operated across the six member states by the regional interbank grouping and carrying 79 participants on the operator's own description	BASELINE NOT HELD

Registries

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
Reference Manual for Civil Registration and Vital Statistics Systems in Central Africa	Did not exist	A common framework for registering births and other vital events across the member states, prepared under a World Bank-financed statistical programme with United Nations population-fund support; no implementation date, member-state adoption count or registration target is published	ADVANCED
Regional support for birth registration	Not held	The Francophonie organisation restated continuing support for advancing birth registration across Central Africa (2025-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD

National statistics

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
BEAC 2026 balance-of-payments data collection	Did not exist	BEAC launched the data-collection phase of its 2026 balance-of-payments exercise across the CEMAC zone; no completion date or published output yet	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
CEMAC harmonised labour-statistics framework	No CEMAC member state runs a regular labour force survey, on the organisers' own statement	World Bank-financed HISWACA workshop, with ILO technical support, produced a regional methodological guide and a preliminary roadmap for quarterly labour-force surveys across the six member states; CEMAC put informal employment above 65% of jobs bloc-wide and unemployment ranging from 1.1% in Chad to nearly 20% in Gabon; a parallel CEMAC/AFRISTAT industrial-production-index workshop (Douala, 10-14 August) worked toward a binding community statistical regulation	ADVANCED
ICT benchmarking across Central Africa	Not held	Funded to benchmark ICTs across the zone's telecommunications regulators and national statistics offices (2021)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Use of satellite data

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
CREWS Central Africa (hydrometeorological early-warning network)	Did not exist	Sub-regional observing and forecasting network feeding the WMO's WIS/WHOS systems, with RSMC-Yaounde issuing regional severe-weather guidance and an ECCAS Situation Room operational at CAPC-AC Douala since September 2024, part of the continental AMHEWAS early-warning system; co-financed by the EU's SEWA programme (US\$2m) and the World Bank (US\$10m, across Chad, the Central African Republic, Rwanda and the DRC). Three further steps are on the record: a November 2025 remote training that had national and regional hydrologists apply satellite precipitation, soil-moisture and water-level altimetry alongside in-situ measurement across the Niger, Chad and Congo basins; a February 2026 agreement on communication and collaboration mechanisms for producing and disseminating early warnings; and a March 2026 regional flood-forecasting training with a data-management framework spanning the community and river-basin memberships	ADVANCED

Payments infrastructure carries the period's clearest delivery: SYSTAC 2 replaced a 2007-vintage retail-clearing platform across all six states, and BEAC's PAPSS accession extends a continental settlement rail into CEMAC, though a month after accession Cameroonian businesses report no working access to it — the qualifying clause the ledger records as "slipped". I-CEMAC's border-data extension and the CREWS hydrometeorological network are the two systems with the longest run of delivery evidence behind them, both citing site-level completion figures rather than plans. Statistics moved on two separate tracks — a balance-of-payments collection and a labour-statistics framework — with the latter's own workshop conceding that no member state currently runs a regular labour force survey. The Central Africa Peering Forum and the PIDA data-centre prospectus are both still announcements: a scheduled event and a published prospectus, neither yet a delivered system.

Capacity and inclusion

Literacy

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
Media and information literacy digital-skills project	Did not exist	A USD 166,800 regional project on media and information literacy and digital skills, reported at 66% overall progress with USD 109,943 spent as it reached its scheduled end; no output, reach or evaluation figure is published	ADVANCED

Training and skills

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
African Institute of Informatics (IAI-Cameroun)	Not held	Operating as an inter-state training institution, with the regional commission opening collaboration on education and digital skills (2026-08)	BASILINE NOT HELD

Access to services

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
Economic inclusion of refugees in Central Africa	Not held	Diagnosed under the regional inclusive and resilient value chains project, following a private-sector-for-refugees framework (2024)	BASILINE NOT HELD

Capacity in this region is held by institutions the base can name and cannot measure. The African Institute of Informatics is inter-state by construction, and the period's only development on it is a [visit from the ECCAS commissioner for gender and human development opening collaboration on education and digital skills](#) — no enrolment, no qualification, no commitment beyond the visit. On the inclusion half, the regional inclusive and resilient value chains project produced [a technical diagnostic of refugees' economic position across Central Africa under a private-sector-for-refugees framework](#), which is a study rather than a programme. Neither row had a position at the start of the period, so both read as baseline not held: the region is building a record on capacity, not yet moving one.

Finance

New investments

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-08	MOVEMENT
Digital Business Boost for Africa grant	Did not exist	A EUR 15m European Union grant, stated as FCFA 9.83bn, covering Cameroon, Gabon, the Democratic Republic of the Congo and Congo, to strengthen the foundations of a safe, inclusive and sustainable digital economy; the implementing bank is named only by nationality and no country split, component list or delivery date is published	ADVANCED

The base holds one regional financing commitment for the period: a [EUR 15m European Union grant covering four of the six member states](#). It is the whole of the section because regional digital financing here is mostly carried inside country programmes and inside the community's own payment-system work, neither of which is a regional commitment this ledger can count. What the grant will fund is not published beyond a statement of purpose, so the sum is the finding and the components are not.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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